



CENTER FOR INDIAN COUNTRY DEVELOPMENT



FEDERAL RESERVE BANK OF MINNEAPOLIS

BECOMING A SURVEY PARTNER

The Survey of Native Nations and related reports are made available to participating tribal governments at no monetary cost. CICD offers technical assistance to support participating tribes in completing the survey—including one-to-one help, regularly scheduled virtual briefings, and an online resource that a tribe's designated respondent can engage in at their own pace. Depending on data availability within a given tribe, survey responses may take anywhere from 2–8 hours to prepare and submit.

If you are interested in participating in the Survey of Native Nations, please use the contact information on this handout to reach out to a member of the project leadership team.

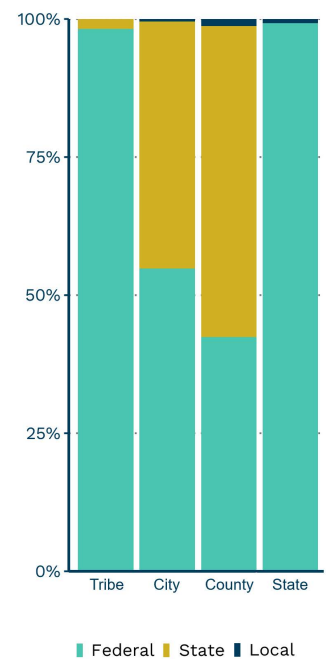


SEPTEMBER 2025

Survey of Native Nations

The Survey of Native Nations is a confidential data collaboration between tribes and CICD. It provides tribal governments with analysis and visualization of the finance data of local governments and the anonymized, aggregated finance data of other participating tribal governments. The survey is a project of the Center for Indian Country Development (CICD), a research and policy institute headquartered at the Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis with a mission to advance the economic self-determination and prosperity of Native nations and Indigenous communities through actionable data and research that inform public policy discussions. Designed prioritizing tribal data sovereignty principles, the Survey of Native Nations leverages the Federal Reserve System's secure data infrastructure.

This innovative initiative reflects CICD's work to address persistent economic data gaps in Indian Country. CICD maintains a suite of regularly updated data tools on our website. Taken together, these tools mark a significant milestone in organizing public economic data about tribal communities. The Survey of Native Nations represents CICD's effort to work with tribes across the country to collect private data directly. Data about the scope of tribal government finance are quite limited. This project aims to address this data gap.



CICD piloted the Survey of Native Nations with tribal governments in Montana and expanded the survey through a second pilot with tribes in the Pacific Northwest to the East Coast. The Survey of Native Nations is now available to all tribes in the United States.

BENEFITS TO TRIBES

The Survey of Native Nations gathers data on tribal government revenues and

expenditures. CICD research and policy experts prepare a confidential report for each participating tribal government. Each report compares the tribe's data to that of other state and local governments as well as anonymized, aggregated data about other tribal government respondents. Tribes benefit from these reports in several ways.

Survey of Native Nations report data are analyzed and visualized to maximize their usefulness in tribal government policy and planning work. Tables, graphs, and analysis of each tribe's selected local comparisons are helpful in supporting data-informed public policy discussions about a tribe's contributions to the local economy. These data can aid a tribe's planning activities by revealing both how other tribes generate revenues and what local governments collect and spend on public services. Survey of Native Nations data and analysis can also be used to enhance and inform internal and external communications with government staff and tribal citizens.

By participating in this survey, tribes are contributing to a broader effort to equip all of Indian Country with greater insight into revenue stream diversification and delivery of public services. Survey response data in aggregate will be used to advance CICD's tribal public finance research on tribal taxation and tribally owned enterprises as well as to enhance the public's understanding of tribal governments' economic contributions to local and regional economies. The Survey of Native Nations is an important milestone in the work to advance economic data infrastructure in Indian Country.

DATA USE AND CONFIDENTIALITY

Protecting tribal government partners' data is CICD's highest priority. The Survey of Native Nations is aligned with tribal data sovereignty principles in several ways. The survey itself is flexible, allowing tribes to determine if and how to share data for nearly all questions. For data security, the project leverages the Federal Reserve System's extensive experience with collecting and safeguarding confidential data for research purposes.

Aggregated and anonymized tribal data are provided in participants' confidential reports only in cases where there are sufficient survey responses to safeguard individual tribes' information. Data used for research purposes would only be published in an aggregated, anonymized format, and internal access to the Survey of Native Nations dataset is controlled and limited by CICD directly.

CONTACT US

CICD has a team to support your participation in the survey. For more information, contact:

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ABOUT CICD

Based at the Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, CICD is a research and policy institute focused on Native economies. We work to advance the economic self-determination and prosperity of Native nations and Indigenous communities through actionable data and research that inform public policy discussions. CICD supports the Minneapolis Fed's mission to serve the public by pursuing a growing economy that works for all of us. CICD is grounded in the Federal Reserve System's community development function, which has responsibility to help improve economic outcomes in low- and moderate-income communities. The Federal Reserve System is the central bank of the United States and was created by the U.S. Congress to provide the nation with a safer, more flexible, and more stable monetary and financial system. The Federal Reserve System has 12 independent Reserve Banks which have a purpose to serve the public.

CICD's work is guided by a Leadership Council that reflects key representatives from national and regional Native organizations, tribal leadership, and tribal economic development and finance practitioners.